

CHIEF MINISTERS' RANK

Centre-state relations are always contentious, whether it is dealing with Opposition chief ministers or those from the Congress and its allies. There are sharp differences of opinion on important issues ranging from the Women's Reservation Bill to tackling security threats.



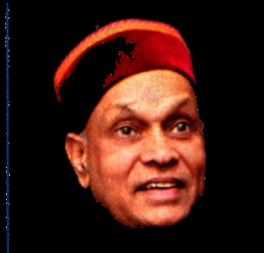
Omar Abdullah
Chief Minister
Jammu & Kashmir



K. Rosaiah
Chief Minister
Andhra Pradesh



Sukhbir Badal*
Deputy Chief Minister
Punjab



Prem Kumar Dhumra
Chief Minister
Himachal Pradesh

How would you rate the UPA II on a scale of 0 to 10?

7.5/10

8/10

3/10

Declined to grade

How would you assess the UPA's second term?

In spite of challenges, the UPA II has done an excellent job of insulating India during recession. Our economy bounced back much faster than many other countries. The commitment to women's reservation was clearly displayed by the passage of the Bill through the Rajya Sabha.

The UPA under the guidance of Sonia Gandhi and the stewardship of Manmohan Singh has been able to sort out differences between the coalition partners and is doing the best possible under the given circumstances. Only an year old, its new initiatives for the poor will only grow.

The Government is directionless and works on a day-to-day basis, rather than trying to find permanent solutions to issues such as the food crisis, Naxalism and several other problems. Also, there are too many power centres.

In its second term, the UPA has been neglecting the Opposition. The Congress is not bothered about its coalition partners. It needs to have 272 seats for a simple majority, but with 204, its behaviour is still not good. The regime has been rather unjust with the states ruled by the Opposition.

Can you list three areas they have succeeded?

Insulating the economy from the worst of recession; landmark legislation of the Right to Education (RTE); and resumption of dialogue with Pakistan.

Unity of the UPA; rural employment through the NREGA; administrative stability and transparency; and lastly, RTE and the Women's Reservation Bill.

There is nothing the Government has done that can make you feel proud or excited.

Nothing except the PM's gentlemanly behaviour. Sarcastically speaking, they have succeeded in centralising power and disuniting the Opposition.

The three important areas they have failed in.

I would not use the term failure but yes there have been challenges. The three important challenges that the UPA faces are: price rise, Naxalism and spurt in violence, and thirdly, a sustained dialogue with Pakistan.

As far as I am concerned, there are no fronts on which the Government has failed.

Price rise; failure of law and order, especially on Naxalism which is spreading its wings—the Government has no plan to combat it; lastly, complete negligence of the farmers.

The Government has failed to check rising prices and on foreign policy matters, they do what the US wants them to do. It has also failed to control terrorism.

Will it last the full term?

Yes, I believe it will.

Yes. Even those who drifted away are once again coming closer.

Due to so many pulls and pressures, it may not last a full term.

So far, they haven't let the Opposition unite, but it may not last.